

DigiPick of the month

Piracy Is Going
Legal!



This month's
winner is

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Participate in this
DigiPick contest and
win

**Visual Basic
Database
Programming**



by Roger Jennings
Published by

WILEY-INDIA

WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject "**DigiPick**" and your postal address **on or before the 15th of this month** to **digipick@thinkdigit.com**. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

question. I don't know. But, frankly, I don't care," said Marchesano, who is not a gamer. "You can't look at these pieces and not be moved by them, intrigued by them."

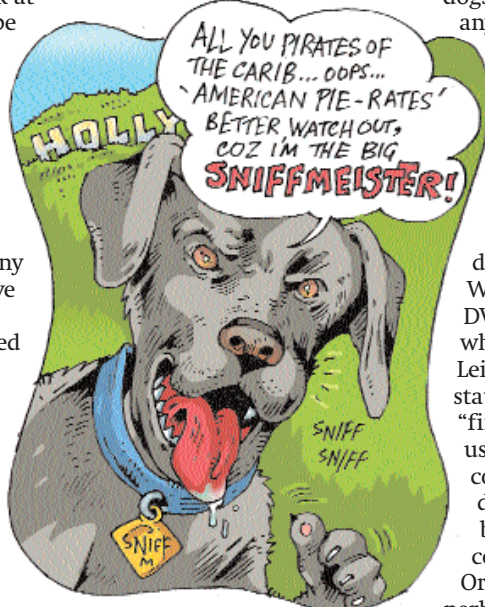
Take a look at the pictures on the previous page, which are quite like what was exhibited at *Into The Pixel*. We think they're stunning. In any case, remember we live in a world where elephant dung smeared on walls and garbage cans overflowing with garbage are considered art!

THE WAR AGAINST PIRATES

Sniff Out The DVDs!

We gave it away in the headline above, but otherwise,

you'd never guess what Hollywood's latest weapon is in its war against movie



piracy. It's Labrador Retrievers. Yes, authorities in the UK are using Labs to sniff out counterfeit DVDs.

Looks like the Motion

Picture Association of America (MPAA) didn't know how much money they were losing to piracy. Because the Association said two black Labradors had been trained by British customs to do the DVD-sniffing job just a few days after a leaked report revealed that \$6.1 billion (Rs 29,000 crore) had been lost to piracy in 2005. The Association did not comment on where they got the idea from.

The two dogs, named Lucky and Flo, have their work cut out at FedEx's British hub at Stansted Airport near London. They can identify DVDs located in envelopes, boxes, or almost any packaging. Naturally, they can also sniff out discs concealed amongst other goods. "This is the first time dogs have been used

anywhere in the world to search for counterfeit DVDs and the results were amazing," said Raymond Leinster, director general of the Federation Against Copyright Theft.

Now it beats us how dogs can sniff out DVDs. We didn't even know DVDs had a smell! Besides, what about CDs? Mr Leinster has qualified his statement very precisely: "first time dogs have been used... to search for counterfeit DVDs." So does he mean they've been used to search for counterfeit CDs before? Or bootlegged VHS tapes, perhaps?

OK, let's assume DVDs smell different from CDs. Next is the question of how the dogs know the DVDs are counterfeit. As far as we know, copies of DVDs are legal,

People Who Changed Computing

The God Of Gaming

Atari founder Nolan Bushnell



Nolan Bushnell

is widely considered the father of the video gaming industry. Bushnell was into games

right from his childhood; he played in chess tournaments in college and loved puzzles and problems. He was one of the many computer science students of the 1960s who played the famous *Spacewar!* game on a DEC mainframe.

While he was learning basic computer graphics at university, he also worked as manager of an amusement park. During this period, he also created a game named *Computer Space*. The game didn't take off because the gameplay was too complex.

It was in 1972 that Bushnell went on to establish the company named Atari. In the first year of his entrepreneurial career, he invented a coin-operated video game, *Pong*, which was a big hit in the gaming console market. *Pong*—essentially a console game based on ping-pong—was simple; the ball would go back and forth between two pads that moved up and down, controlled by players using control knobs. At this time, coin-based video games were in vogue, and PC games were almost non-existent.

Atari soon introduced the Atari 2600 Video Console System, which revolutionised the home video game market and started a new era in game consoles. While at Atari, Bushnell invented 20 games. He sold the company in 1976 to Warner Communications, and in the following year opened Chuck E Cheese's pizza restaurant, which offered both fast food and electronic games. To date, Bushnell has founded 18 companies, one of them a home robotics company.